

A New Handoff System at Meridian Repair - Core Meaning Practice

A longer mixed-skill passage set with closer answer choices and no teaching during the attempt.

GED Practice - Core Meaning

Suggested time: 12-15 minutes. Read the passage, answer all questions, and check explanations only after you finish.

Meridian Repair Services maintains commercial refrigeration equipment for supermarkets and restaurants. Because technicians work in morning, afternoon, and overnight shifts, one employee often begins a repair that another employee must finish. For years, outgoing technicians left short notes in a paper binder near the dispatch desk. The binder was familiar, but the notes varied widely. Some contained detailed measurements, while others simply said that a unit still needed work.

The inconsistency became more noticeable as the company took on additional clients. A technician starting a shift might spend twenty minutes repeating a pressure check because the previous worker had not recorded the result. In other cases, dispatch staff had to call an off-duty employee to ask which replacement part had already been ordered. Managers did not believe the employees were careless; the problem was that the old system did not make clear which information every handoff should contain.

Meridian tested a digital handoff form for six weeks. The form asked outgoing technicians to record the equipment number, symptoms observed, tests completed, measurements taken, parts ordered, safety concerns, and the next recommended step. It also allowed a photograph to be attached when a damaged component was difficult

to describe. The form could not be submitted if the equipment number and next-step fields were blank.

The company did not want the form to replace direct conversation. During the pilot, technicians were still expected to speak with the incoming shift when a repair involved a serious safety risk or an unusual problem. Supervisors described the form as a common starting point, not a complete substitute for judgment. That distinction became important during the second week, when several technicians complained that the first version of the form required too much typing for simple repairs. Managers shortened two sections and added check boxes for routine tests.

At the end of the pilot, the company compared service records with those from the previous six weeks. Repeat diagnostic checks had decreased, and dispatch staff made fewer calls to off-duty technicians for missing information. The average time between an incoming technician opening a job and beginning the next repair step also fell. However, the company found no meaningful change in the total time required for very complex repairs, which often depended on parts availability or access to a customer's equipment room.

Technicians' comments were similarly mixed but useful. Most preferred having the recent measurements in one place. Several said that photographs helped them understand damage before arriving at a site. A few still felt the form could encourage people to write instead of speaking when a complicated situation really needed discussion.

Meridian kept the digital form but changed its training. New guidance now explains which information belongs in the form and which situations require a direct conversation as well. The company's conclusion was not that written handoffs solve every communication problem. Instead, a consistent record reduced avoidable information gaps, while direct discussion remained important when the repair itself was unusual or risky.

Questions

1. Which problem with the old paper-binder system is directly stated?

- A. Employees refused to leave any notes at the end of a shift.
- B. The binder could not be used by overnight employees.
- C. Important repair information was recorded inconsistently, sometimes forcing later workers to repeat checks or seek missing details.
- D. Managers required every technician to call an off-duty employee before beginning work.

2. Which statement best expresses the central idea of the passage?

- A. A structured digital handoff reduced avoidable information gaps, but Meridian kept direct conversation for unusual or risky repairs and adjusted the form based on worker feedback.
- B. Digital forms are always more reliable than spoken communication in technical workplaces.
- C. The main reason complex repairs took a long time was that technicians failed to complete handoff forms.
- D. Meridian's pilot succeeded mainly because technicians could attach photographs.

3. Which detail provides the strongest evidence that the new handoff system reduced avoidable information gaps?

- A. Technicians could attach photographs to the form.
- B. The form required an equipment number and a next-step field.
- C. Managers shortened two sections after technicians complained about typing.
- D. Repeat diagnostic checks decreased and dispatch staff made fewer calls to off-duty technicians for missing information.

4. Which choice best summarizes the part of the passage describing changes made during the six-week pilot?

- A. Managers removed direct conversation because the form already contained every necessary detail.
- B. Meridian kept direct conversation for certain repairs and simplified the form after technicians said the first version required too much typing.
- C. Technicians refused to use the form until photographs were added.
- D. Supervisors replaced the digital form with a shorter paper checklist.

5. Which statement best summarizes the passage?

- A. Meridian replaced all spoken handoffs with a digital form that solved delays in complex repairs.
- B. Technicians preferred photographs, so Meridian created a form mainly to store images of damaged equipment.
- C. Meridian tested and refined a digital handoff form that improved consistency and reduced some repeated work, while keeping direct discussion for complicated or risky situations.
- D. The company ended the pilot because technicians believed the form required too much typing.

6. According to the passage, when were technicians still expected to speak directly with the incoming shift?

- A. When a repair involved a serious safety risk or an unusual problem.
- B. Whenever a photograph was attached to the form.
- C. Only when the equipment number field was blank.
- D. After every routine diagnostic test.

7. Which detail best supports the idea that the handoff form improved efficiency for ordinary work but did not remove every source of delay?

- A. The old binder sat near the dispatch desk.
- B. Photographs helped technicians understand some damaged components.
- C. Managers added check boxes for routine tests.
- D. Incoming technicians began the next repair step sooner on average, but total time for very complex repairs did not meaningfully change because other factors still mattered.

Answer key & reasoning

1. C - R1.1

The passage describes notes that varied widely and gives repeated checks and phone calls as consequences.

Use again: Explicit questions can combine details the passage directly states, but they still must not add a new rule.

2. A - R1.2

Choice A covers the original problem, the form, its measurable benefits, the limits of written handoffs, and the revised training.

Use again: A main idea should explain both the benefit and the limitation that the passage develops.

3. D - R1.3

Choice D directly measures two problems caused by missing information and shows both decreased.

Use again: Prefer outcome evidence over a feature that merely seems helpful.

4. B - R1.4

The pilot section emphasizes keeping conversation for high-risk or unusual work and simplifying the form after feedback.

Use again: A section summary should preserve the main changes rather than one feature.

5. C - R1.4

Choice C keeps the original problem, pilot, measured improvement, refinement, and continuing role of conversation.

Use again: The best summary includes both what changed and what the company learned about the limits of that change.

6. A - R1.1

The passage directly names serious safety risk or an unusual problem as situations requiring direct conversation.

Use again: Keep the condition exactly as written.

7. D - R1.3

Choice D directly supports both parts: improved handoff efficiency and continued delays in complex work.

Use again: For a two-part claim, prefer evidence that addresses both parts.

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